Microsoft

Maturity Model for Microsoft 365 Practitioners

June 2026

Revisit the People and Communities Competency



✨ **Guest star** ✨ Tracy van der Schyff

Current Core Team

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Emeriti

Emily Mancini, Left Uncharted | @eemancini

Initiative started by Sadie [Van Buren] Gilronan as the SharePoint Maturity Model in 2010

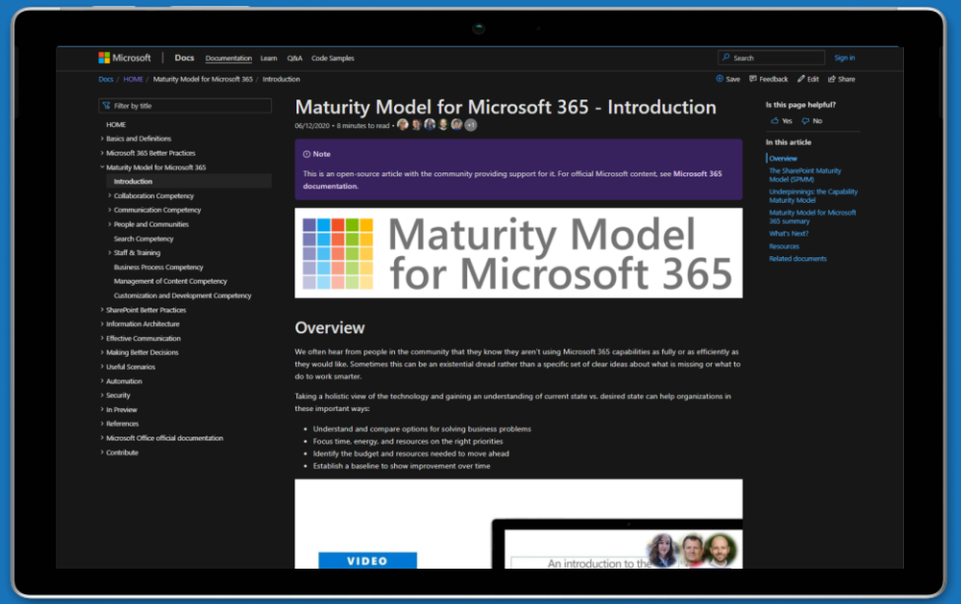
Agenda

Practitioner & Maturity Model overview

- Artifacts and Updates
- Purpose

Contribute

The main event



https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/community/index-mm4m365
or https://symp.info/MM4M365

Reminders

Join us every month!

Download the recurring calendar series

https://aka.ms/mm4m365/invite

Global Microsoft 365 & Power Platform Meetup

https://www.meetup.com/global-microsoft-365-dev-meetup/events/

Purpose and articles on Microsoft Learn

PURPOSE

- Improve organization through use of technology
- Benchmark company and department
- Select appropriate approach
- Develop an organizational business and technical roadmap based on:
  - What's possible
  - What's desired
  - Organization's culture and drivers
- Lead and support strategic planning, with senior management
- Align implementation needs and objectives
- Discuss use of the platform with IT – not just technology
- Socialization tool

Artifacts

Published competencies

- AI & Cognitive Business ✨
- Business Process ✨
- Collaboration ✨
- Communication ✨
- Customization & Development ✨
- Employee Experience ✨
- Governance, Risk & Compliance ✨
- Infrastructure ✨
- Management of Content ✨
- People & Communities
- Search ✨
- Security
- Staff & Training

✨ = Key actions highlighted

How to elevate...

- Collaboration
- Communication
- People & Communities
- Staff & Training
- Governance, Risk and Compliance
- Security

Practical Scenarios

- Microsoft 365 Service Change Management
- Servicing Microsoft 365 Apps
- Servicing Health Management
- Enhancing Brand Management
- Knowledge Management

Supporting articles

- Search
- Communication

Tools

- Running a MM4M365 workshop
- Practitioner meeting recordings

In progress competencies

- Data & Analytics

M365 Community Docs
https://aka.ms/m365-community-docs

Artefacts, structure, and scope

The Maturity Model

- Competencies
- Principles
- How to elevate…
- Practical scenarios

Competencies

- Overview etc.
- Evolution
  - Characteristics grouped by sub-competency
  - Level 100-500
- Scenarios, Costs & Benefit, Conclusion
- Microsoft 365 Toolsets
- Resources & contributors

Sub-competencies

- Group characteristics into common categories
- Some consistency across competencies

Characteristics

- Grouped by Level
- Grouped by sub-competency
  - Sparkled
  - Unsparkled

Business capability (Competency)

Business activities (Scenarios)

Technologies (Microsoft 365 Toolsets)

Business Functions

Markets

MM4M365 provides benchmarks to measure your organization

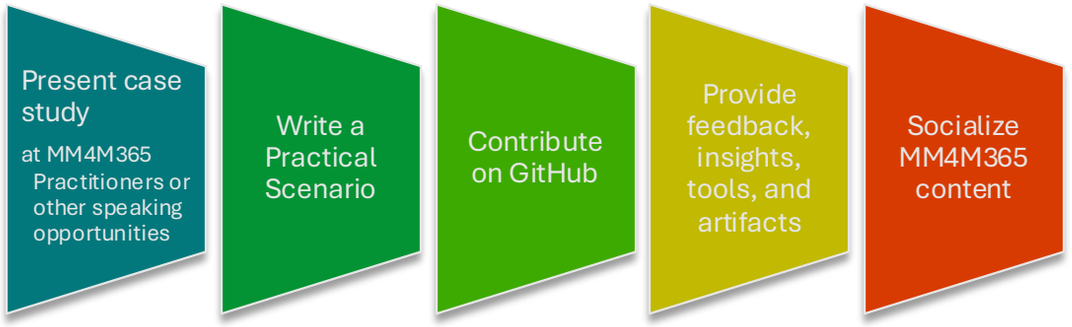
Maturity Level	Description/characteristics	Intent
Level 500 Optimizing	Optimal, systematic, statistical, improvement-focus, automated, assured, proactive	“We want to ensure all the key processes are always effective and resilient, while designing the same into anything new we do”
Level 400 Predictable	Productive, interactive, responsive, enhanced, effective, adaptable, quality	“Let’s make things even better by measuring, analyzing and taking actions to improve based on that“
Level 300 Defined	Documented, policy-driven, planned, controlled, stable	“We have defined our processes, policies and procedures, everyone seems to be doing the right thing; let’s keep doing that”
Level 200 Managed	Routine, legacy, fire-fighting, variable, personally managed	“We should ensure everyone knows what they should be doing”
Level 100 Initial	Ad hoc, reactive, uncontrolled, chaotic, unstable, not designed	“Let’s keep putting the fires out and keep the lights on!”

Overview

Practitioners for Maturity Model for Microsoft 365

Get Involved

https://symp.info/SiCCommunityContentGuide



Run a MM4M365 workshop

- https://symp.info/MM4M365Workshop

Purpose

Safe space to:

- Share & test your thoughts
- Guide the process and content
- Decide how to promote your use of the Maturity Model
- Hone your pitch

Discussion-based monthly meeting

- Understand the competencies & measuring maturity
- Awareness of new assets
- Feedback on the maturity model
- Share anecdotes and success stories
- Map technology, maturity level & competencies
- Run workshops

Upcoming topics in 2026

January 20	February 17	March 17	April 21	May 19	June 16
Maturity Model for Microsoft 365 Agent	MM4M365 AMA	Security Competency	Revisiting the Staff and Training Competency	Frontier Firm: Maturity Model Perspective	Revisit the People and Communities Competency
⭐ Simon Doy ⭐	⭐ Everyone ⭐	⭐ Mats Warnolf ⭐ ⭐ Clement Betacorne ⭐	⭐ Emily Mancini ⭐	⭐ Merethe Stave ⭐	⭐ Tracy van der Schyff ⭐

July 21	August 18	September 15	October 20	November 17	December 15
Summer break	*Summer break*	Revisiting the Governance, Risk, and Compliance Competency	Modern Compliance in Microsoft 365: A Maturity Model Perspective	TBD	*Winter break*
None	None	⭐ Nikki Chapple ⭐	⭐ Joanne Klein ⭐	TBD	None

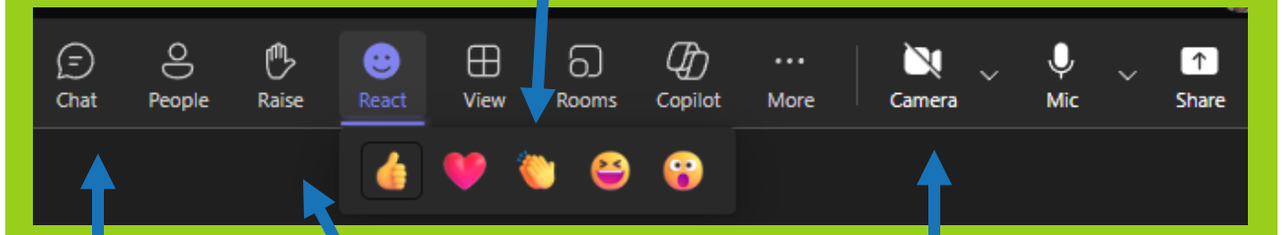
The Main Event

Revisit the People and Communities Competency

PROTOCOL

Visually emote and support
Share reactions while others are speaking

Come off mute and share your thoughts



Ask questions, offer insights, talk to each other

Raise your hand to say your piece (and put it down again!)

Share your camera (don’t be shy)


We learn through storytelling
Daily Affirmations
Share Your Ideas. Change Perspectives. Build Community.
Stay Curious
PEOPLE FIRST
COMMUNITY IS POWER
VULNERABILITY CONNECTS
PERSPECTIVE SHIFTS
BETTER TOGETHER
Listen.
Stories



Tracy van der Schyff

Owner: The Guid Stuff / Microsoft 365 & Copilot MVP

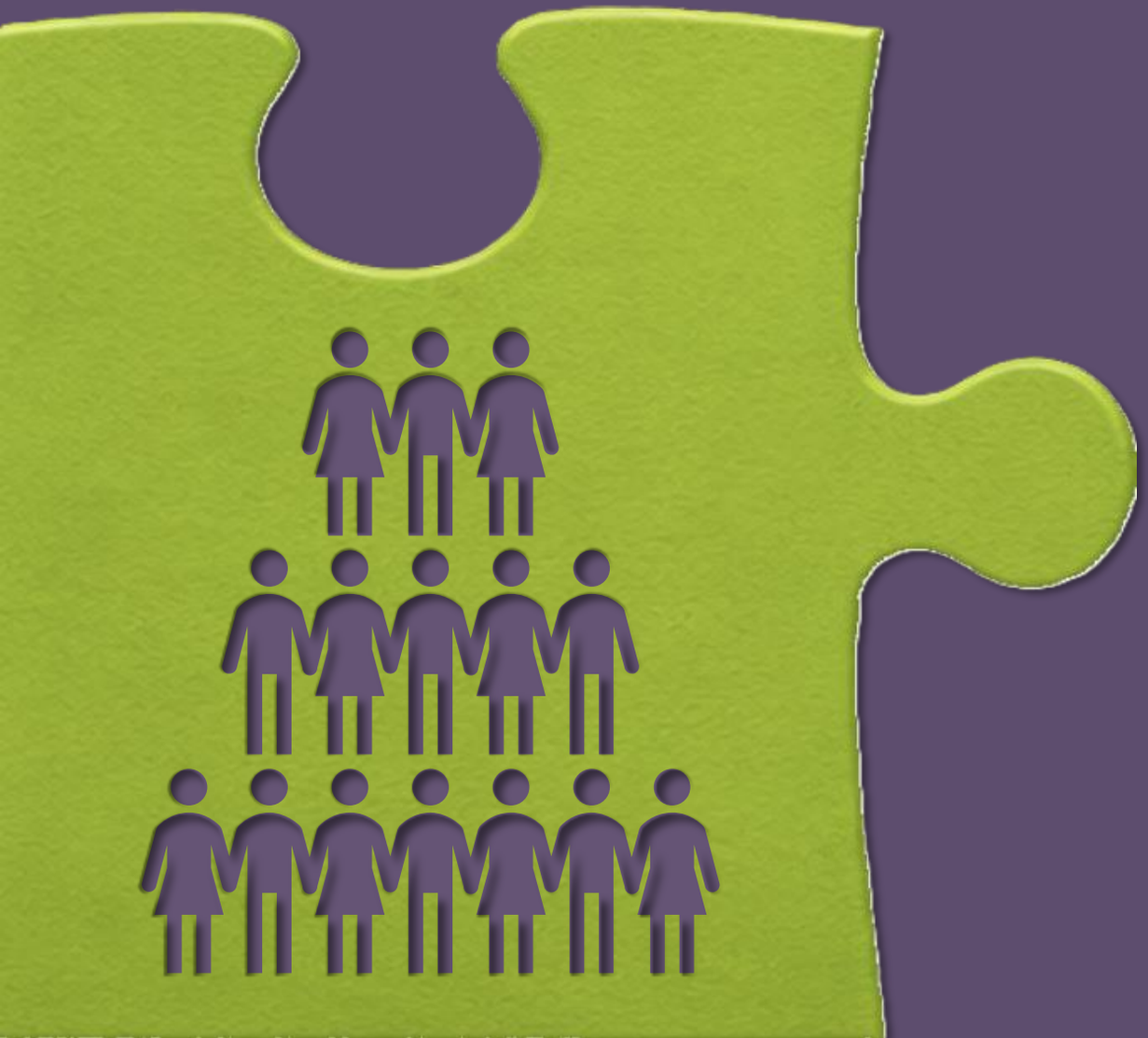
https://tracyvanderschyff.com



What does “People & Communities” mean?

From the model itself:


Maturity Model
AI and Cognitive Business
Business Process
Collaboration
Communication
Customization and Development
Employee Experience
Governance Risk and Compliance
Infrastructure
Management of Content
People and Communities
Search
Security
Staff and Training
For Microsoft 365



I'm not saying PEOPLE AND COMMUNITIES should be the CORNERSTONE (puzzle piece), but somehow, they always end up being exactly that!

People & Communities Competency

The most important part?

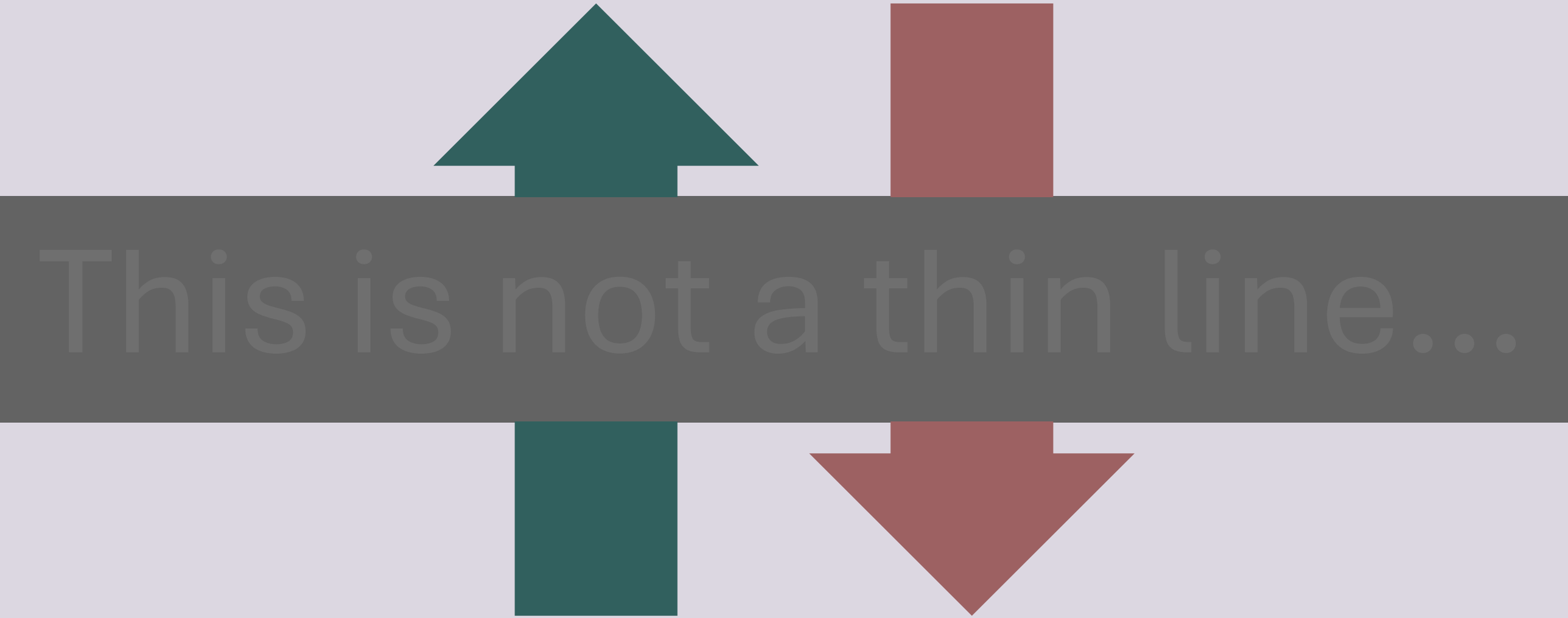


Maturity Model
for Microsoft 365

you

Are we allowing employees time to participate in communities?




This is not a thin line...

Community focuses on peer-to-peer interaction, not top-down communication.

- **Work is no longer location-bound**
- Information is massively unstructured
- **AI is now part of the “community”**

“People & Communities” in 2026

- People connected by context, not org structure
- Conversations that flow across tools
- Knowledge that is continuously shaped
- AI helping surface who and what matters

Community is no longer where you go, it’s what happens when people, knowledge, and context come together.

The model describes the components, but in reality, the challenge isn’t building communities, it’s making them visible, usable, and valuable in a noisy, AI-driven world.



- Communities are no longer optional nice-to-haves. They are now part of how organizations learn, discover expertise, and scale knowledge.
- Tools matter less than culture, but the tool ecosystem now matters more than it did in 2022, because communities are now connected into Microsoft 365 groups, Teams experiences, and AI-assisted knowledge flows.
- The real maturity jump is not from “no communities” to “communities exist”. It is from people talking to people finding, learning, contributing, and improving together, with governance and signal, not noise.

That is the modern People & Communities competency!

Level	Behaviour (What you actually see happening)
Level 100 – Initial	
Level 200 – Managed	
Level 300 – Defined	
Level 400 – Predictable	
Level 500 – Optimized	

Build Intranets & Communities for the People who **USE** them, not the People who **PAY** for them...

- Are your communities helping people work or just talk?
- Can people find expertise without knowing who to ask first?
- Is AI amplifying your knowledge flow or exposing your chaos?
- Are you measuring participation, or actual value?

Points to Ponder


Real conversations create real change.
Be Present
What feels forced at first, Becomes culture over time.
Curiosity
Connection
Community
PEOPLE FIRST
SHARE KNOWLEDGE
BE VULNERABLE
BUILD COMMUNITY
CREATE CHANGE
Ideas

Thank you

Next MM4M365 monthly call

September 15 – 10 ET / 7 PT

Third Tuesday of every month: https://aka.ms/mm4m365/invite

Stay in touch

- Articles: https://aka.ms/m365-community-docs
- Newsletter: Sign up
- LinkedIn group: Maturity Model for Microsoft 365 Community
- YouTube: http://mmvideos.m365.ms/
- Slide decks: https://symp.info/MM4M365Slides
- Twitter/X: @M365Maturity | @M365CommDocs | #MM4M365
- BlueSky: @mm4m365.org

Take the Maturity Model Self-Assessment

- Fill out the Maturity Model Survey: https://symp.info/MM4M365Survey






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